

Coffee Shop Comparison Tool

Time: 20 minutes | AI-Assisted Coding

TL;DR

Build a web app that loads `coffee_shop_reviews.csv` and compares coffee shops.

Success = CSV loads + shops displayed + some form of comparison

QUICK START (Pick One)

Before you prompt: Take 60 seconds to decide what you actually want to build. What metrics matter? What comparison makes sense? Your first prompt should reflect *your* vision, not a template.

Option 1: Python + Web Framework

Best for those comfortable with Python. Gives you pandas for data manipulation.

Option 2: Single HTML File (No Setup Required)

Zero dependencies. Just open in browser. Great if you want to avoid environment issues.

Option 3: Your Preferred Stack

Use whatever you're comfortable with. The goal is speed, not tech elegance.

Success Tiers

Tier	What it means	Concrete example
Bronze	Data loads and displays	Table showing 5+ shops with name, rating, price
Silver	Compare shops meaningfully	Side-by-side view OR chart comparing 2+ shops
Gold	Interactive + polished	Filtering, search, multiple viz, clean UI

Bronze = “It works.” CSV parses, data renders, no crashes.

Silver = “It’s useful.” A user could actually compare two shops and make a decision.

Gold = “It’s impressive.” You’d demo this without caveats.

Aim for Silver. Bronze is acceptable. Gold is a stretch goal.

Data Source

File: `coffee_shop_reviews.csv`

Contains: - Shop name, address, neighborhood - Ratings (overall, coffee quality, service, atmosphere) - Pricing (regular coffee, cappuccino, specialty drinks) - Wait times and operating hours - Amenities (WiFi, outlets, seating, parking, mobile ordering) - Review counts and customer data

Tip: Open the CSV in your editor first to see the column names.

Track What Works

As you build, note: - Which prompts worked first try? - What needed clarification or retry? - Where did you spend the most time?

This helps you build better prompts in future exercises.

Common Pitfalls

Pitfall	Solution
Spending 5+ min debating tech stack	Pick one and GO
Hand-writing CSV parsing	Let AI generate it
Perfectionist UI design	Functional first, pretty later
Complex comparison logic	Simple side-by-side works
npm install issues	Use Option 2 (single HTML)
Prompting without a mental model	Know what you want <i>before</i> you ask

Success Checklist

- ☐ CSV data loaded into application
 - ☐ At least 5 coffee shops displayed
 - ☐ Shows 5 key metrics per shop
 - ☐ Some form of comparison (visual OR side-by-side)
 - ☐ Application runs without errors
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Example Implementation

Note: `example_implementation.png` shows a complex, feature-rich dashboard that would take hours to build. This is NOT what's expected in 20 minutes.

For this exercise: - A simple HTML table is perfectly fine - Basic cards showing shop info work great - A single bar chart comparing 2-3 shops is excellent - Plain styling is totally acceptable

Your 20-minute solution should be MUCH simpler than the example image.